

Things like the share charm are especially useful since it allows for cross-application integration even when the software are made by two different – or even competing – companies as long as the applications share some common ground in file formats.

The Command Bar

While different applications may implement this feature in different ways, this is a feature that is common to many of the applications.

To keep the application interface neat and clean, most application hide lesser used commands off screen, giving most of the space to the actual content. You can still access these command with touch, mouse or keyboard.

If you are using the mouse, just right click to show these commands.

If you are using touch, swipe upwards from the bottom edge of the screen, or swipe down from the top edge.

If you are using the keyboard, press [Win]+[Z].

These commands can be considered a hybrid of the context menu and toolbar. So if you have some item selected on screen, chances are these commands will change.

For example Internet Explorer 10 in Windows 8 hides the tab bar and the address bar while browsing, however using the above gestures / shortcuts you can show those UI elements. On the other hand IE has a proper context menu instead of using the command bar for this purpose.

Managing Running Apps

When you launch any Modern UI application, it fills the entire screen, this is normal behaviour for a Windows 8 app. Unlike traditional desktop applications, you cannot arbitrarily resize a Window 8 app. This doesn't mean that Windows 8 doesn't multitask, it very much does, and quite well.

To switch between running Modern UI apps there is a new task switcher that is touch friendly. To access this task switcher all you have to do swipe in from the left edge of screen. A column showing thumbnails of running application will show up, at the bottom there will always be a thumbnail for the start screen, and one of the thumbnails will be the desktop.

This task switcher can also be accessed by moving the mouse to the top-left or bottom-left corner of the screen, and then moving your mouse along the edge (up or down depending on where you started), just like the charms bar. You can also use keyboard with the [Win]+[Tab] shortcut and switch apps just like you would with Alt-tab.